

Fintech Sentiment Intelligence Analysis

Executive Summary

Project Duration: 2 weeks

Dataset: 25,000+ customer reviews

Apps Analyzed: Chime, Cash App, Venmo, PayPal, Zelle

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Objective

Analyze customer sentiment across 5 major fintech apps to: 1. Identify hidden pain points and crisis language patterns 2. Build an AI-powered severity detection system 3. Provide competitive intelligence and actionable insights

Key Achievements

Model Performance Improvements

- **+87% increase** in severity detection accuracy (macro-F1: 0.16 → 0.30)
- **+17% increase** in high-severity issue detection (F1: 0.47 → 0.55)
- **-6% reduction** in negation-related errors

Business Value Delivered

- **707 hidden negatives identified** (complaints disguised as positive reviews)
- **Crisis keyword lexicon** built with 50+ fintech-specific terms
- **Interactive dashboard** enabling real-time competitive analysis
- **200 reviews hand-labeled** for validation ground truth

Critical Findings

1. Account Access Issues Drive Severity

35% of high-severity complaints involve locked/frozen accounts

- Keywords: "frozen", "locked", "can't access", "suspended"
- Average severity: **4.2/5**
- Recommendation: Prioritize account access team & improve unlock processes

2. Hidden Negatives in Positive Reviews

707 reviews (2.8%) rated 4-5★ but contain severe complaints

- Example: "Love this app! But my account has been frozen for 3 weeks..."
- Risk: Traditional sentiment analysis misses these entirely
- Solution: Our severity-based detection flags them automatically

3. Competitive Landscape

App	Avg Rating	Negative %	Avg Severity	Hidden Neg
Cash App	4.07★	14.6%	1.77	137
Chime	3.89★	18.4%	1.97	229
PayPal	3.43★	25.0%	2.15	156
Venmo	3.31★	28.2%	2.25	185
Zelle	3.28★	26.8%	2.18	142

Insight: Cash App leads in customer satisfaction; Venmo has highest complaint rate



Technical Approach

Data Pipeline

1. **Scraped 25,000+ reviews** from Google Play Store
2. **Cleaned & normalized** text (removed duplicates, fixed encoding)
3. **Built sentiment engine** using VADER with custom enhancements
4. **Validated model** on 200 hand-labeled reviews

AI Enhancements

- **Negation Handling:** Pre-processes "not good" → correctly classified as negative
- **Crisis Lexicon:** 50+ fintech keywords (fraud, frozen, hacked, dispute)
- **Severity Scoring:** 1-5 algorithm combining sentiment intensity + crisis keywords + star rating
- **Hidden Negative Detection:** Flags positive/neutral sentiment with high severity

Tech Stack

- **Languages:** Python 3.9+
- **NLP:** VADER, NLTK, spaCy
- **Data:** Pandas, NumPy
- **Visualization:** Streamlit, Plotly, Seaborn



Business Impact

For Product Teams

- ✓ **Prioritize features** based on severity-weighted complaints
- ✓ **Track trends** over time to measure improvement
- ✓ **Compare** against competitors for positioning

For Customer Support

- ✓ **Auto-flag critical cases** (severity 4-5) for immediate escalation
- ✓ **Identify hidden complaints** missed by traditional filters
- ✓ **Reduce response time** for urgent money/access issues

For Marketing

- ✓ **Benchmark sentiment** against competitors
 - ✓ **Craft messaging** addressing top pain points
 - ✓ **Highlight strengths** relative to competition
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Deliverables

- ✓ **Interactive Dashboard** (4 pages, 15+ charts)
 - ✓ **Sentiment Engine** (`src/analysis.py` - production-ready)
 - ✓ **Validation Report** (200-review ground truth)
 - ✓ **Crisis Keyword Lexicon** (50+ terms)
 - ✓ **GitHub Repository** (fully documented)
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Recommended Next Steps

Short-term (1-3 months)

- Deploy sentiment engine as **REST API** for real-time monitoring
- Set up **automated daily scraping** for trend tracking
- Integrate with **support ticketing system** for auto-escalation

Medium-term (3-6 months)

- Expand to **iOS App Store** reviews
- Add **Spanish language support** (large fintech demographic)
- Build **predictive churn model** based on review patterns

Long-term (6-12 months)

- Implement **BERT-based sentiment** for higher accuracy
 - Add **aspect-based analysis** (what specific features are complained about)
 - Create **executive dashboard** with weekly trend alerts
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Skills Demonstrated

- ✓ **Data Engineering:** Web scraping, ETL pipelines, data cleaning
 - ✓ **NLP & Machine Learning:** Sentiment analysis, text classification, model validation
 - ✓ **Product Analytics:** User research, competitive analysis, insight generation
 - ✓ **Data Visualization:** Interactive dashboards, storytelling with data
 - ✓ **Software Engineering:** Clean code, documentation, version control
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Contact

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